

CHEATSHEET · QUICK REFERENCE

Lab 6 — Installing a Server Operating System (Unattended / Scripted)

Validate minimum spec and HCL, build a cloud-init autoinstall seed.iso, capture a golden image and walk the P2V and install-type decisions.

Pre-install validation

```
lscpu | grep -E "Architecture|CPU\(s\)"
Confirm architecture and CPU count

free -h
Confirm RAM meets minimum spec

lsblk
Confirm disk meets minimum spec

dmidecode -s system-product-name
Model string for the HCL lookup
```

Unattended install (cloud-init)

```
genisoimage -output seed.iso -volid cidata -joliet -rock user-data meta-data
Build the autoinstall seed

autoinstall ds=nocloud-net
Kernel cmdline to consume the seed at boot
```

Imaging, cloning and templates

```
tar --one-file-system --exclude=/proc --exclude=/sys -czf /srv/golden.tgz /
Capture a golden image

cloud-init clean
Sysprep: clear instance state before redeploy

debootstrap --variant=minbase jammy /srv/template http://archive.ubuntu.com/ubuntu/
Build a template root filesystem

qemu-img convert ... disk.qcow2
Image a disk for P2V
```

Install-type decision table

Install type	When to use
GUI	Admin workstation, training labs
Core	Production - smaller attack surface
Bare metal	Single-tenant, max performance
Virtualized	Most production - consolidation, snapshots
Remote	Branch / lights-out via PXE / IP KVM